

THEME 5 · B1.1

Life in the House & Neighbourhood

Types of houses, rooms, furniture and activities in the house

Warm-up

Look at the title: Life in the House & Neighbourhood. What do you think we will talk about in this theme? Tell your partner two ideas.

By the end of this theme...

1. I can describe your house or flat, its rooms and furniture
2. I can talk about your usual chores and routines at home
3. I can say what you and your family are doing at the moment
4. I can ask and answer about a partner's dream house and neighbourhood

VOCABULARY

New words

23 target words

block of flats

noun phrase · /blɒk əv flæts/



apartman, blok

We live on the fifth floor of a big block of flats.

villa

noun · /'vɪlə/



villa

My uncle has a villa with a swimming pool near the coast.

cottage

noun · /'kɒtɪdʒ/



kulübe, küçük ev

We spend every summer in my grandparents' cottage in the countryside.

detached house

noun phrase · /dɪ'tætʃt haʊs/



müstakil ev

A detached house doesn't share a wall with the house next door.

apartment

noun · /ə'pɑ:tment/



daire

Our new apartment has three bedrooms and a big balcony.

garden

noun · /'gɑːdn/



bahçe

My mum grows tomatoes and flowers in the garden.

balcony

noun · /'bælkəni/



balkon

We often have breakfast on the balcony in the summer.

kitchen

noun · /'kɪtʃɪn/



mutfak

My dad is cooking dinner in the kitchen right now.

bathroom

noun · /'bɑːθruːm/



banyo

There is a shower and a bathtub in our bathroom.

living room

noun phrase · /'lɪvɪŋ ru:m/



oturma odası

In the evening, we relax together in the living room.

bedroom

noun · /'bedru:m/



yatak odası

I always tidy my bedroom on Sunday mornings.

hallway

noun · /'hɔ:lweɪ/



koridor, antre

We keep our shoes in the hallway, near the front door.

bathtub

noun · /'bɑːθtʌb/



küvet

My little sister loves playing with her toys in the bathtub.

oven

noun · /'ʌvən/



fırın

My grandmother is baking bread in the oven at the moment.

fridge

noun · /frɪdʒ/



buzdolabı

There isn't much food in the fridge, so we need to go shopping.

wardrobe

noun · /'wɔːdrəʊb/



gardırop

I hang my school uniform in the wardrobe every night.

sofa

noun · /'səʊfə/



kanepe

My cat is sleeping on the sofa right now.

pillow

noun · /'pɪləʊ/



yastık

There are two soft pillows on my bed.

rug

noun · /rʌg/



halı, kilim

There's a colourful rug in the middle of the living room.

neighbour

noun · /'neɪbə(r)/



komşu

Our neighbours often have a barbecue in their garden at the weekend.

neighbourhood

noun · /'neɪbəhʊd/



mahalle, semt

There is a small park and a bakery in our neighbourhood.

to iron

verb · /'aɪən/



ütü yapmak

My mum is ironing my school shirt at the moment.

to relax

verb · /rɪ'læks/



dinlenmek, rahatlamak

On Sundays, we usually relax at home and don't do much housework.

Quick game · What's the word?

“**ütü yapmak**”

a to iron

b balcony

c bedroom

Quick game · What's the word?

“fırın”

a kitchen

b bedroom

c oven

Quick game · What's the word?

“oturma odası”

a living room

b cottage

c detached house

Quick game · What's the word?

“mahalle, semt”

a pillow

b neighbourhood

c living room

Quick game · What's the word?

“halı, kilim”

a rug

b to relax

c kitchen

Quick game · What's the word?

“yatak odası”

a bedroom

b bathroom

c bathtub

GRAMMAR

Simple Present vs Present Progressive: routines and now

Notice

I **usually clean** my room on Saturdays, but right now I **am tidying** the kitchen.

My mum **doesn't cook** every day, but she **is cooking** dinner at the moment.

Our neighbours **often have** a barbecue in their garden, and look — they **are having** one now!

Do you **iron** your own clothes? — Not usually, but I **am ironing** them this evening.

**Which verbs talk about habits and routines? Which verbs talk about what is happening right now?
What word tells you which tense to use?**

Complete the rule

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

Simple Present

Present Progressive

habits and routines

now / at the moment

Complete the rule

We use the _____ for _____ that are generally true, like household chores we always do.

✓ **Simple Present**

Complete the rule

We use the _____ for actions happening _____, around this time.

✓ **Present Progressive**

Complete the rule

Words like 'usually', 'often' and 'every day' usually go with the _____ .

✓ Simple Present

Complete the rule

Words like 'now', 'right now' and 'at the moment' usually go with the _____ .

✓ Present Progressive

The rule

We use the Simple Present for habits, routines and general truths about our house and family. We use the Present Progressive (am/is/are + verb-ing) for actions happening right now or around this time.

TR Simple Present, ev ile ilgili alışkanlıkları, rutinleri ve genel doğruları anlatmak için kullanılır. Present Progressive ise şu anda veya bu günlerde devam eden eylemleri anlatmak için kullanılır (am/is/are + fiil-ing).

When? We use the Simple Present to talk about household chores and routines, and the Present Progressive to describe what is happening at home right now.

TR Ev işlerinden ve rutinlerinden bahsederken Simple Present, o anda evde ne olduğunu anlatırken Present Progressive kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

I + usually / clean + my room on Saturdays

I usually clean my room on Saturdays.

Build sentences

my mum

+

cook

+

dinner right now

My mum is cooking dinner right now.

Build sentences

we

+

not / relax

+

in the garden every evening

We don't relax in the garden every evening.

Build sentences

? / your neighbours

+

have

+

a barbecue at the moment

Are your neighbours having a barbecue at the moment?

Build sentences

I + iron + my school shirt now

I am ironing my school shirt now.

Build sentences

? / you + tidy + your bedroom every day

Do you tidy your bedroom every day?

Your turn

Write four sentences about your house: two about things you usually do at home, and two about what you or your family are doing right now.

I usually...

My family usually...

Right now, I am...

At the moment, my...

Form

POSITIVE

I tidy my room every day.
She is ironing her school shirt now.

NEGATIVE

We don't relax in the garden every evening.
He isn't cooking dinner at the moment.

QUESTION

Do you iron your own clothes?
Are your neighbours having a barbecue now?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, I do. / No, I don't.
Yes, they are. / No, they aren't.

Error detective

I am tidy my room every day.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **I tidy my room every day.**

Error detective

She cook dinner right now.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **She is cooking dinner right now.**

A · Choose the correct option.

My mum _____ dinner every evening, but right now she
_____ the living room.

a cooks / is cleaning

b is cooking / cleans

c cook / is clean

A · Choose the correct option.

Look! Our neighbours _____ a barbecue in the garden.

a have

b are having

c has

A · Choose the correct option.

I usually _____ my bedroom on Saturday mornings.

a tidy

b am tidying

c tidies

A · Choose the correct option.

_____ you iron your own clothes?

a Are

b Do

c Is

B · Complete with the correct tense.

My dad _____ (relax) on the sofa right now.

✓ is relaxing

B · Complete with the correct tense.

We _____ (not/have) a garden — we live in a block of flats.

✓ **don't have**

C · Judge the sentence.

She is iron her school shirt every morning.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **She irons her school shirt every morning.**

C · Judge the sentence.

At the moment, my grandmother is baking bread in the oven.

a Correct

b Incorrect

Dialogue · Complete with the correct tense.

A: What _____ you _____ (do) right now?

✓ are / doing

Dialogue · Complete with the correct tense.

B: I _____ (tidy) my bedroom. I always _____ (do) this on Sundays.

✓ **am tidying / do**

Dialogue · Complete with the correct tense.

Make a question about a current action.

living

are

the

you

relaxing

in

room

?

✓ **Are you relaxing in the living room?**

GRAMMAR

There is / There are + prepositions of place

Notice

There is a big garden behind our house.

There are two bathrooms in our new apartment.

The sofa is **between** the window and the bookshelf.

Is there a balcony in your flat? — Yes, **there is**.

Which sentences use 'there is' and which use 'there are'? Why? What prepositions show where things are?

Complete the rule

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

There is

There are

singular

plural

Complete the rule

We use ' _____ ' with a _____ noun (one thing).

✓ **There is**

Complete the rule

We use ' _____ ' with a _____ noun (more than one thing).

✓ **There are**

Complete the rule

In a question, we say 'Is there...?' with a _____ noun.

✓ **singular**

Complete the rule

In a question, we say 'Are there...?' with a _____ noun.

✓ plural

The rule

We use 'there is' with singular nouns and 'there are' with plural nouns to say that something exists in a place. We use prepositions of place (in, on, behind, between, next to) to say exactly where something is.

TR 'There is' tekil isimlerle, 'there are' çoğul isimlerle bir yerde bir şeyin var olduğunu anlatmak için kullanılır. Bir şeyin yerini belirtmek için 'in, on, behind, between, next to' gibi edatlar kullanılır.

When? We use this to say what rooms or furniture a house has, and exactly where they are.

TR Bir evde veya odada hangi eşyaların/odaların bulunduğunu ve bunların tam olarak nerede olduğunu anlatırken kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

a big garden

+

behind

+

our house

There is a big garden behind our house.

Build sentences

two bathrooms

+

in

+

our new apartment

There are two bathrooms in our new apartment.

Build sentences

not / a fridge

+

in

+

the hallway

There isn't a fridge in the hallway.

Build sentences

? / a balcony

+

in

+

your flat

Is there a balcony in your flat?

Build sentences

a rug

+

between

+

the sofa and the TV

There is a rug between the sofa and the TV.

Build sentences

? / any wardrobes + in + your bedroom

Are there any wardrobes in your bedroom?

Your turn

Write four sentences about your own house or flat using there is/there are and at least two prepositions of place (in, on, behind, between, next to).

There is...

There are...

There isn't...

Is there...?

Form

POSITIVE

There is a garden behind our house.

There are two bedrooms upstairs.

NEGATIVE

There isn't a fridge in the hallway.

There aren't any pillows on the sofa.

QUESTION

Is there a balcony in your flat?

Are there any wardrobes in your bedroom?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, there is. / No, there isn't.

Yes, there are. / No, there aren't.

Error detective

There is two bathrooms in our flat.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **There are two bathrooms in our flat.**

Error detective

The rug is between the sofa and.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ The rug is between the sofa and the TV.

A · Choose the correct option.

_____ a small garden behind our cottage.

a There is

b There are

c They are

A · Choose the correct option.

_____ **three bedrooms in our new apartment.**

a There is

b There are

c It is

A · Choose the correct option.

The wardrobe is _____ the bed and the window.

a between

b behind

c in

A · Choose the correct option.

_____ any pillows on your sofa?

a Is there

b Are there

c Do there

B · Complete with there is/there are.

_____ a big oven in our kitchen.

✓ **There is**

B · Complete with there is/there are.

_____ (not) a balcony in our old flat.

✓ **There isn't / There is not**

C · Judge the sentence.

There is two fridges in our kitchen.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **There are two fridges in our kitchen.**

C · Judge the sentence.

There is a rug next to the sofa.

a Correct

b Incorrect

Dialogue · Complete with there is/there are.

A: _____ a garden in your new house?

✓ Is there

Dialogue · Complete with there is/there are.

B: Yes, _____. And _____ a small balcony too.

✓ there is / there is

Dialogue · Complete with there is/there are.

Make a question about furniture in a bedroom.

bedroom

the

are

any

in

there

wardrobes

?

✓ **Are there any wardrobes in the bedroom?**

READING

My Dream Cottage in the Countryside

Before you read

1. Look at the title. What do you think this blog post will describe?
2. Guess: what three rooms or things might the writer mention?

MY DREAM COTTAGE IN THE COUNTRYSIDE · 1 / 5

Hi, readers! I'm Aslı, and today I want to tell you about my family's little cottage in the countryside, near my grandparents' village. We usually spend every summer holiday here, and it's my favourite place in the world.

MY DREAM COTTAGE IN THE COUNTRYSIDE · 2 / 5

Our cottage isn't very big — it has a kitchen, a living room, two bedrooms and one bathroom. There is a small bathtub in the bathroom, and there is a big old fridge in the kitchen that always makes a funny noise! My favourite room is the living room, because there is a soft sofa with colourful pillows, and a warm rug on the floor.

MY DREAM COTTAGE IN THE COUNTRYSIDE · 3 / 5

Behind the cottage, there is a lovely garden with apple trees and vegetables. My grandmother usually works in the garden every morning, but this morning she is relaxing on the balcony instead, because it's raining. My grandfather often relaxes in his favourite chair after lunch, and right now he is reading the newspaper there.

MY DREAM COTTAGE IN THE COUNTRYSIDE · 4 / 5

We don't have a big wardrobe like at home, so we usually keep our clothes in a small suitcase! My mum is ironing our clothes for tomorrow at the moment, because we're going to visit our neighbours for dinner.

MY DREAM COTTAGE IN THE COUNTRYSIDE · 5 / 5

I love our cottage because it's quiet and simple. There isn't a lot of furniture, but there is a lot of love in this little house. Every summer, I look forward to coming back here.

While you read

What is the text mainly about?

a A hotel in the city

b Aslı's family cottage in the countryside

c How to build a house

While you read

How many bedrooms does the cottage have?

a One

b Two

c Three

While you read

What is Asli's favourite room, and why?

a

The kitchen, because of the fridge

b

The living room, because of the sofa and rug

c

The bathroom, because of the bathtub

While you read

What is Asli's grandmother doing this morning, according to the text?

a Working in the garden

b Relaxing on the balcony

c Ironing clothes

While you read

The cottage has a big wardrobe for their clothes.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ The cottage doesn't have a big wardrobe — they keep their clothes in a small suitcase.

While you read

Why does Aslı say there is 'a lot of love' in the cottage?

a

Because it has
expensive furniture

b

Because it's a big,
modern house

c

Because it's a simple
place where her family
spends happy time
together

After you read

1. If you had a small cottage in the countryside, which room would be your favourite? Write two sentences.
2. Compare Asli's cottage with your own house. Find one similarity and one difference.

READING

A Day in Our Neighbourhood

Before you read

1. What do you think happens in a typical neighbourhood on a normal day?
2. Guess two things neighbours might do together.

A DAY IN OUR NEIGHBOURHOOD · 1 / 5

I live in a block of flats in a friendly neighbourhood, and I love watching what happens outside my window every day. Right now, it's Saturday morning, and our neighbourhood is full of activity.

A DAY IN OUR NEIGHBOURHOOD · 2 / 5

Mr. Aydın, who lives in the villa opposite our building, usually works in his garden on Saturdays, and today he is exactly that — planting flowers near his front gate. His neighbour, Mrs. Kaya, often has coffee on her balcony in the morning, and she is doing that right now too, waving to everyone who passes by.

A DAY IN OUR NEIGHBOURHOOD · 3 / 5

Down the street, a family in a detached house is having a small barbecue in their garden, even though it's still morning! Their children usually play football in the street after school, but today, because it's the weekend, they are already outside with a ball.

A DAY IN OUR NEIGHBOURHOOD · 4 / 5

My own family doesn't usually do much on Saturday mornings — we normally relax at home. But today is different: my dad is washing our car, my mum is tidying the living room, and I am helping my little brother clean his bedroom.

A DAY IN OUR NEIGHBOURHOOD · 5 / 5

Later, we are all meeting our neighbours for a small neighbourhood picnic in the park nearby. I really enjoy living here — everyone knows everyone, and there is always something interesting happening on our street.

While you read

What is this text mainly about?

a A trip to another city

b A busy Saturday in the writer's neighbourhood

c How to plant a garden

While you read

What is Mr. Aydın doing right now?

a Washing his car

b Planting flowers in his garden

c Having a barbecue

While you read

What does Mrs. Kaya often do in the morning?

a

Have coffee on her balcony

b

Play football in the street

c

Clean her bedroom

While you read

What is the writer's family doing this morning?

a

Relaxing all morning, as usual

b

Washing the car, tidying and cleaning

c

Having a picnic in the park

While you read

The writer's family usually does a lot of activities on Saturday mornings.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ The writer's family doesn't usually do much on Saturday mornings — today is different.

While you read

What can we infer about the neighbourhood at the end of the text?

a

The neighbours don't know each other well

b

It's a friendly place where neighbours spend time together

c

The writer wants to move away

After you read

1. What do people in your neighbourhood usually do at the weekend? Write two sentences.
2. Write two sentences about what your family is doing right now, at this moment.

LISTENING

House-Hunting with Mum

Before you listen

1. You will hear a mother and her son visiting a new apartment with an estate agent.
2. Guess: what three questions might they ask about the apartment?

House-Hunting with Mum

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

Agent Welcome! So, this apartment has three bedrooms, a kitchen, a living room and two bathrooms.

Mum That sounds great. Is there a balcony? My son loves having breakfast outside.

Agent Yes, there is — it's just through the living room. Come and see.

Deniz Wow, this living room is big! Is there space for a sofa and a rug here?

Agent Definitely. And look, there's a modern kitchen with a new oven and a big fridge.

Mum Perfect. Are there any wardrobes in the bedrooms, or do we need to buy our own?

Agent There are built-in wardrobes in two of the bedrooms.

Deniz Mum, I really like this apartment. Can we take it?

Mum Let's think about it, but I'm relaxing already just imagining our new home!

While you listen

How many bedrooms does the apartment have?

a Two

b Three

c Four

While you listen

Why does Mum ask about the balcony?

a

She wants to grow vegetables there

b

Her son loves having breakfast outside

c

She wants to iron clothes there

While you listen

What does the kitchen have, according to the agent?

a

A new oven and a big fridge

b

A bathtub and a wardrobe

c

A sofa and a rug

While you listen

How many bedrooms have built-in wardrobes?

a One

b Two

c Three

While you listen

Deniz doesn't like the apartment at all.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Deniz really likes the apartment and wants to take it.**

After you listen

1. Would you like to live in this apartment? Why or why not?
2. Write two questions you would ask about a new house or flat.

LISTENING

What Are You Doing Right Now?

Before you listen

1. You will hear a phone call between two friends, Ela and Cem, on a Sunday afternoon.
2. Predict: what do you think they are doing at home?

What Are You Doing Right Now?

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

Ela Hi, Cem! What are you doing right now? I'm bored.

Cem Hi, Ela! I'm helping my dad in the garden. We're planting some flowers.

Ela That sounds nice. I don't usually do gardening, but I love relaxing outside sometimes.

Cem What about you? What's happening at your house?

Ela My mum is cleaning the kitchen, and my brother is tidying his bedroom. I'm just sitting on the sofa, watching them!

Cem Ha! Do you usually help with the housework?

Ela Sometimes. I usually iron my own clothes, but I don't like cleaning the bathroom.

Cem Me neither! Hey, do you want to come to my house later? We can relax in the living room.

Ela Sure, that sounds great. See you soon!

While you listen

What is Cem doing right now?

a Cleaning the kitchen

b Planting flowers in the garden with his dad

c Watching TV

While you listen

What is Ela's mum doing?

a Cleaning the kitchen

b Ironing clothes

c Planting flowers

While you listen

What does Ela usually do, but not like doing?

a Ironing her clothes

b Cleaning the bathroom

c Sitting on the sofa

While you listen

Ela is helping her mum clean the kitchen right now.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Ela is just sitting on the sofa, watching her family do the housework.**

While you listen

What do Cem and Ela decide to do later?

a Do more housework

b Meet and relax in the living room

c Go to the park

After you listen

1. What are you usually doing on a Sunday afternoon?
2. Write one sentence about what you are doing right now, at this exact moment.

SPEAKING

Describe Your Dream House

Imagine your dream house (real or invented, for creative-writing purposes). Describe its rooms and furniture to your partner using vocabulary and 'there is/there are', while your partner draws a simple sketch based on your description.

1. Think of your dream house: type of house, number of rooms, key furniture.
2. Describe it to your partner, room by room, while they sketch it.
3. Your partner asks 2-3 follow-up questions with 'Is there...?' or 'Are there...?'
4. Swap roles and repeat with your partner's dream house.
5. Compare your sketches and share one interesting detail with the class.

There is a... / There are...

It's a villa/cottage/apartment with...

The... is next to/between/behind the...

In the living room, there is...

SUPPORT

Give students a simple house outline with room labels to guide the description.

CORE

Full description with at least 6 pieces of furniture/rooms and 2 follow-up questions.

EXTENSION

Fast finishers add two sentences with the Present Progressive about what is happening in a room right now.

SPEAKING

What's Happening at Home? — Phone Roleplay

Roleplay a phone call between two friends. One friend asks what the other is doing right now at home, and what they usually do at the weekend, using the Simple Present and the Present Progressive.

1. In pairs, decide who calls first.
2. Caller asks what their partner is doing right now.
3. Partner answers with the Present Progressive, then adds what they usually do (Simple Present).
4. Swap roles and repeat with a new situation.
5. Perform your best phone call for another pair.

What are you doing right now?

I'm ...-ing at the moment.

What do you usually do at the weekend?

I usually... but today I'm...

SUPPORT

Give a phone-call script frame with gaps for lower-level students.

CORE

A full phone call with at least 4 exchanges, mixing both tenses correctly.

EXTENSION

Fast finishers add an invitation to visit and describe a room they will relax in.

WRITING

My House

Write a short description of your own house or flat (or an invented one, for creative-writing purposes) for a new pen pal. Include the type of house, its rooms, at least three pieces of furniture, and one sentence about what your family usually does there.

1. Choose a title for your description, e.g. 'My Apartment' or 'My Family's Cottage'.
2. Note the type of house and the number of rooms.
3. List three or four pieces of furniture using 'there is/there are'.
4. Add one sentence with the Simple Present about a family routine at home.
5. Check your grammar and punctuation.

apartment

living room

bedroom

kitchen

sofa

wardrobe

There is... / There are...

My house/flat has...

In the... there is/are...

We usually...

WRITING

My Neighbourhood

Write a short blog post about your neighbourhood (real or invented, for creative-writing purposes) for the school website. Describe what your neighbours usually do, and what is happening in your street right now.

1. Choose a title for your blog post, e.g. 'A Day in My Neighbourhood'.
2. Say what kind of neighbourhood it is (quiet, busy, friendly).
3. Describe two things neighbours usually do there, using the Simple Present.
4. Say two things that are happening right now, using the Present Progressive.
5. End with one sentence about why you like (or don't like) your neighbourhood.

neighbour

neighbourhood

garden

balcony

to relax

to iron

My neighbourhood is...

Our neighbours usually...

Right now, ...

I like/don't like living here because...

REVIEW

Exit ticket

Exit ticket

Choose the correct meaning: 'neighbourhood'

a a piece of furniture

b the area around your home where you live

c a type of house

Exit ticket

What does 'cottage' mean?

a

a small house, often in the countryside

b

a large block of flats

c

a piece of furniture

Exit ticket

I usually _____ my bedroom on Saturdays.

a tidy

b am tidying

c tidies

Exit ticket

Look! My dad _____ dinner in the kitchen right now.

a cooks

b is cooking

c cook

Exit ticket

_____ a big garden behind our house.

a There is

b There are

c It is

Exit ticket

_____ any wardrobes in the bedrooms?

a Is there

b Are there

c Do there

Exit ticket

In 'My Dream Cottage in the Countryside', what is Aslı's favourite room?

a The kitchen

b The living room

c The bathroom

Exit ticket

The cottage has a big wardrobe for the family's clothes.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ The cottage doesn't have a big wardrobe — they keep their clothes in a small suitcase.

Exit ticket

In 'A Day in Our Neighbourhood', what is Mr. Aydın doing right now?

a Washing his car

b Planting flowers in his garden

c Having a barbecue

Exit ticket

_____ you iron your own clothes? (soru: Simple Present)

✓ Do

Exit ticket

_____ two bathrooms in our new apartment. (there is/there are)

✓ **There are**

Exit ticket

Which word means 'a person who lives near you'?

a neighbour

b landmark

c wardrobe